

CREDIT CARDS

■ By Malini Bhupta

Yogesh Chaudhary, 37, can't remember the last time he carried more than 5 per cent of his cash in his wallet because the combined limit on his five credit cards is more than sufficient for his expenses. While Chaudhary has been using a credit card for over a decade, he began substituting his cash with cards only a few years back. If one talks of the banking revolution which has fu-

elled consumption, much of it is due to the 100 million-strong credit and debit cards. From being a credit-shy population, consumers are today paying through credit cards, while the circulation of debit cards is 77 million. Sachin Khandelwal, head of the Card Products Group at ICICI Bank, says, "Most banks are issuing ATM-cum-debit cards. But spends on debit cards are low compared to an average

Plastic POWER

This 3X2 inch piece of fibreglass packs more punch than a pocketful of currency notes and has made keeping-track-of-crumpled-notes look like a habit from the Jurassic era. The card does take the credit for a shopping revolution.

SWEETINDER SINGH

SWIPE HAPPY: Consumers now prefer paying through credit cards

